

EPL Predictor — Rules, Site Audit & Launch Plan

Premier League 2026/27 Season · Prepared for internal use

1. Official Competition Rules

These rules are written to be published as-is on the predictor site (e.g. a "Rules" page linked from the footer and registration flow).

1.1 Eligibility & Entry

- Open to residents of India, aged 18 and above at the time of registration.
- One account per person. An account is tied to one unique email address and one unique phone number — both must be verified by one-time code before the account is active.
- Duplicate accounts (same person, multiple emails/numbers) will be merged or removed at Redfooty's discretion, and forfeit any accumulated points.
- Employees, moderators, or immediate family of anyone involved in operating Redfooty or judging the competition are welcome to play but are not eligible to win prizes.
- Registration remains open all season, but points can only be earned for gameweeks predicted after signup — there is no retroactive scoring.

1.2 How Scoring Works

- Each Premier League fixture offers three outcomes to predict: Home Win, Draw, Away Win.
- Correct result (Home Win or Away Win correctly predicted): +5 points.
- Correct draw predicted: +6 points (weighted higher, as draws are statistically harder to call).
- Incorrect prediction: 0 points. There is no negative scoring.
- Predictions lock at kickoff for each fixture and cannot be changed after that point.

1.3 Participation Requirement — the 75% Rule

To keep the competition fair for consistent players, prize eligibility is tied to participation, not just points:

- The Premier League 2026/27 season runs 38 gameweeks.
- A player must submit at least one prediction in 75% of gameweeks (29 of 38) to remain eligible for a prize.
- "Submitting a gameweek" means predicting at least one fixture in that gameweek before it locks — partial gameweeks still count toward the 75% threshold, but only correctly-predicted fixtures earn points.
- Players below the 75% participation threshold can continue playing and appear on the leaderboard, but are flagged as "not currently eligible" and cannot claim a top-3 prize even if their points would otherwise qualify.
- Postponed or abandoned fixtures are excluded from both scoring and the participation count for everyone.

1.4 Prizes & Payout

Place	Prize	Payout method & timing
1st	Original football jersey (winner's choice of club/player/season) + dinner for two	Jersey ordered and dinner scheduled within 7 days of the final Premier League gameweek
2nd	₹5,000 cash + dinner for two	Cash transferred and dinner scheduled within 7 days of the final Premier League gameweek
3rd	₹5,000 cash	Cash transferred within 7 days of the final Premier League gameweek

- Cash prizes are transferred via UPI/bank transfer to the verified phone number/account on file — winners must confirm payout details within 7 days of being notified, or the prize may be forfeited and re-awarded to the next eligible player.
- The jersey is ordered from an authorised retailer; delivery timelines depend on stock/customisation and will be communicated to the winner directly.

1.5 Tie-Breakers

If two or more eligible players finish level on points, ties are broken in this order:

- 1. Higher number of correctly predicted draws (rewards the harder skill).
- 2. Higher gameweek participation percentage.
- 3. Earlier account registration date.
- 4. If still tied, a sudden-death predictor question on the final matchday (e.g. predict the exact scoreline of a nominated fixture) will decide it.

1.6 Fair Play & Disqualification

- One person, one account. Using multiple accounts, bots, or scripts to submit predictions is grounds for disqualification and forfeiture of all points.
- Redfooty reserves the right to review any account showing suspicious patterns (e.g. impossible submission speed) before finalising prizes.
- Abuse, harassment, or spam directed at other players or Redfooty staff will result in removal from the competition.

1.7 Prediction Deadlines

- Each fixture's predictions lock at its official kickoff time (IST).
- The site displays a live countdown per fixture; no predictions are accepted after lock, no exceptions for missed deadlines.

1.8 Disputes

- Any scoring or eligibility dispute must be raised within 7 days of the gameweek results being published.
- Redfooty's decision on scoring, eligibility, and prize allocation is final.

2. Predictor Site — Audit & Improvement Roadmap

Based on the current build (Predict / Results / Table / You tabs), here's what's solid, what's missing, and what to prioritise before public launch.

2.1 What's already working

- Clear core flow: fixtures listed by gameweek, three-way prediction buttons with points shown upfront.
- Prediction lock countdown per fixture — correct and necessary for fairness.
- Account area shows key details and supports secure password change via emailed code.
- Cumulative season leaderboard structure already scoped.

2.2 Gaps & recommendations

Area	Gap	Recommendation	Priority
Rules visibility	No rules page linked in the app itself	Publish Section 1 of this doc as a permanent "Rules" page, linked from nav, footer, and registration step	High
Eligibility tracking	No visible participation % per player	Show each player's gameweek participation (e.g. progress ring, see mockup) so the 75% rule is transparent, not a surprise at payout time	High
Leaderboard depth	Only overall standings implied	Add filters: Overall / This Gameweek / Eligible Only (mirrors the mockup), so eligible players can see a "real" ranking among themselves	Medium
Reminders	No visible notification system	Build the 48-hour email/SMS reminder flow (see Section 3)	High
Duplicate accounts	One-email/one-phone rule not yet enforced in UI	Add server-side checks at registration to block duplicate email or phone across accounts	High
Dispute/support path	No visible contact or help option	Add a simple "Report an issue" link (mailto or form) on Results/Table pages	Medium
Empty & error states	"No finished matches yet" is good, but check other empty/error states (e.g. failed prediction submit)	Write plain-language copy for every empty/error state before launch, in the app's voice	Medium
Branding consistency	Predictor uses a plain dark theme with green accents; redfooty.com uses maroon/black/teal with a bold condensed display font	Restyle the predictor to the site's palette and type system so both feel like one product (see attached mockup)	High
Mobile check	Not verified in the recording	Test the full predict-and-submit flow on a real phone before go-live — most traffic from a YouTube CTA will be mobile	High
Data privacy	Account page shows email/phone in plain text on screen	Fine for the user's own account view, but confirm no other player can query/see another player's contact details via API or UI	High

Area	Gap	Recommendation	Priority
Terms/Privacy on predictor	redfooty.com has Privacy Policy/Terms in the footer; unconfirmed whether the predictor subdomain does	Link the same Privacy Policy/Terms (updated to mention prediction data + prize payout data) from the predictor footer too	Medium

3. Automated Reminder Workflow

Goal: every registered player gets an email + SMS/WhatsApp nudge 48 hours before their gameweek's first fixture locks, so participation (and the 75% eligibility rule) stays healthy without manual work.

3.1 Trigger logic

- For each upcoming gameweek, identify the kickoff time of its first fixture.
- 48 hours before that kickoff, trigger the reminder job for every verified, active account that has not yet predicted any fixture in that gameweek.
- Skip anyone who has already submitted at least one prediction for the gameweek — don't send unnecessary reminders.
- Send a second, shorter reminder 4-6 hours before the first fixture locks, to anyone still not predicted (last-chance nudge).

3.2 Channels & content

Channel	Timing	Content
Email	48h before	“Gameweek [N] opens in 2 days — predict now” + fixture list + direct link to Predict tab
SMS / WhatsApp	48h before	Short version: “GW[N] predictions open — lock in your picks: [link]”
Email or push	4-6h before lock	“Last chance for GW[N] — predictions lock at [time]”, only to non-predictors
Email (monthly)	Once a month	Optional: personal recap — current rank, points, and participation % so far, to reinforce the 75% requirement

3.3 Suggested implementation approach

- Store each fixture's kickoff time and each account's prediction status in the existing database (already in place per your description).
- A scheduled job (cron, or a serverless scheduled function) runs daily, checks which gameweeks are 48h/6h from lock, and queries which accounts haven't predicted yet.
- Email delivery: a transactional email provider (e.g. Postmark, SendGrid, Resend) integrated with your existing OTP/email verification system.
- SMS/WhatsApp: a provider such as Twilio or an official WhatsApp Business API integration — WhatsApp typically has better open rates in India than SMS.
- Log every reminder sent (channel, account, gameweek) so you can debug and avoid double-sends.

- Include a one-tap unsubscribe/preferences option for reminder channels, to stay compliant and avoid spam complaints.

4. Social Media Outreach Plan

Objective: drive registrations for the predictor before Gameweek 1 (Aug 22) and keep engagement high across the season.

4.1 Channels & role

Channel	Role
YouTube (main channel)	Primary launch driver — dedicated announcement video + pinned link in every video description/community post through GW1
Instagram (@redfooty)	Daily-friendly teasers, prize reveals, countdown stories, winner shout-outs
Twitter/X (@Redfooty_in)	Real-time gameweek hype, live prediction reminders, leaderboard updates
Email list (redfooty.com signup)	Direct registration push — warmest audience, highest conversion
WhatsApp community/broadcast (if available)	48h reminders + a sense of a real community, not just a leaderboard

4.2 Content collateral to prepare

- Launch video (YouTube, 4-6 min): explain the competition, prizes, rules, and how to register — clear on-screen CTA + link in description.
- 60-90 sec vertical cut of the launch video for Instagram Reels / YouTube Shorts / Twitter.
- 3-4 static/carousel posts for Instagram: (1) prize reveal, (2) “how it works” 3-step graphic, (3) countdown to GW1, (4) “meet the leaderboard” teaser.
- Countdown graphic template (reusable) for the 18 days to Aug 22, posted every few days with a different angle (prize focus, rules reminder, “last X days to register”).
- Pinned comment / community post template with the registration link for every video published between now and GW1.
- A short explainer graphic of the scoring system (+5 result / +6 draw) and the 75% eligibility rule — this will get asked about, so pre-empt it.
- Weekly “current leaderboard” snapshot graphic once the season starts, posted after each gameweek — strong recurring content that needs little new effort.

4.3 Suggested cadence (launch week through GW1)

When	Action
Launch day	YouTube announcement video goes live; Instagram + Twitter posts same day; email blast to list
Launch +2 days	Reels/Shorts countdown posted; Twitter thread breaking down prizes + rules

When	Action
Mid-countdown	“How scoring works” explainer post; reminder in every subsequent video's pinned comment
3 days before GW1	“Last chance to register before GW1” push across all channels
GW1 day	Live-tweet / story reactions during matches, tie back to “have you predicted?” for anyone not yet in
GW1 + 2-3 days	First leaderboard snapshot posted once results are in — shows the competition is real and live

4.4 Ideas to maximise reach

- Ask early registrants to share a “I’ve made my GW1 predictions” story/post tagging @redfooty — consider a small shout-out or bonus entry incentive for the first 50-100 who do.
- Cross-promote with other India-based football/LFC fan pages or podcasts for launch week, if any relationships exist.
- Use YouTube Community tab polls (“Who wins Arsenal vs Coventry?” style) in the run-up to drive curiosity toward the full predictor.
- Feature the current leaderboard leader (with permission) in a short video/story each month — gives players a reason to aim for the top, and gives you free recurring content.

5. Launch Project Plan — This Week

Target: predictor live and announced on YouTube by end of this week, well ahead of Gameweek 1 on August 22.

Day	Focus	Key tasks
Day 1	Fix & finalise the site	Load real GW1-38 fixtures (replace placeholders); fix broken “Football Fans Cheering” image on redfooty.com; add real testimonial content or remove the placeholder stat
Day 1-2	Rules & policy	Publish Section 1 rules as a live page on the predictor; link Privacy Policy/Terms from the predictor footer
Day 2	Eligibility & duplicate checks	Add server-side one-email/one-phone enforcement at registration; add participation % to account/leaderboard views
Day 2-3	Reminders	Stand up the 48h/6h reminder job (Section 3) — even a simple email-only version is fine for launch, SMS/WhatsApp can follow
Day 3	Visual polish	Apply the redfooty.com brand system (palette, type, leaderboard styling) to the predictor — see attached mockup as reference
Day 3-4	Content production	Film and edit the launch video; produce the Shorts/Reels cutdown and static prize/rules graphics
Day 4	QA pass	Full run-through on mobile: register → verify → predict → view leaderboard; fix anything broken

Day	Focus	Key tasks
Day 5	Launch	Publish YouTube video; post across Instagram/Twitter/email/WhatsApp same day; pin registration link everywhere
Day 5 → Aug 22	Sustain momentum	Countdown posts every 2-3 days; “last chance” push 3 days before GW1; monitor registrations and duplicate-account flags

A same-day HTML mockup of the restyled landing page and leaderboard is attached alongside this document for the visual-polish step.